Out of Nothing, by a Word

Genesis 1:1–2:3

The big idea: God made everything out of nothing by his word, in a careful pattern of forming and filling, and called it very good. The world is not an accident; it was made through his Son.

Before you meet: Read

Genesis 1:1–2:3 | John 1:1–3

Open (5 minutes)

When have you seen something in creation that made you stop and wonder? What was it?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

And God _____, "Let there be light," and there was light. *(Genesis 1:3)*

"And God saw everything that he had made, and behold, it was very _____." *(Genesis 1:31)*

"In the beginning, God _____ the heavens and the earth." *(Genesis 1:1)*

Discuss

1. Our culture says people are for being happy, for achieving, or for being true to themselves. How does Genesis 1–2 answer the question differently? *Genesis 1:26–28*

2. On the first three days God forms; on the next three he fills. What does that pattern tell you about the God who made the world? *Genesis 1:1–2:3*

3. God called the physical world very good. Where have you seen people, even Christians, treat the body or the material world as less than good? *Genesis 1:31; 1 Timothy 4:4*

Memory verse

"And God saw everything that he had made, and behold, it was very good."

Genesis 1:31

Pray

Thank God for three ordinary things today that you did not make and could not make. Thank him that the world was made through Christ.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 5

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Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Genesis 1:1–2:3 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the three fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Genesis 1:26–2:25 and Psalm 8).

Main points to land

1. God made everything out of nothing by his word, in an ordered pattern of forming and filling, and called it very good (Genesis 1; Hebrews 11:3; WSC 9).
2. The material world is good. Bodies, food, work, marriage, and rest are gifts made through Christ and for him (Genesis 1:31; Colossians 1:16; 1 Timothy 4:4).
3. All things were made through the Son, and the same Son came into the world to rescue it (John 1:3; Colossians 1:16).

Answer key (Observe)

1. said
2. good
3. created

Questions people will ask

Were the days of Genesis 1 ordinary 24-hour days?

This study takes them as ordinary days, and the Westminster Confession says God created in the space of six days (WCF 4.1; see Exodus 20:11). Faithful Reformed teachers have also read them as long ages or as a literary framework. All of them hold that God made everything out of nothing, by his word, and that Adam was a real man. Keep the group on that main point.

Closing prayer

Creator God, you spoke and the world appeared, and you called it very good. Thank you for every good gift we did not make. Thank you that all things were made through your Son. Teach us to receive your world with thanks. Amen.